

POLICY

| ITWORKS | 172

Title

Malicious Software Protection Policy

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1 Policy

IT WORKS will implement controls to protecting information assets from exposure to malicious software.

This policy supports and extends the IT WORKS Information Security Policy.

2 Scope

This procedure applies to the prevention of malicious software in IT WORKS ICT environments. The scope of this policy includes server, desktop, laptop and other mobile computer equipment used to conduct IT WORKS related functions:

- whether owned or leased directly by IT WORKS, or provided for IT WORKS use by an External Service Provider
- whether located in IT WORKS or at other locations.

3 Definitions

Malicious Software	Any software that is designed for a malicious purpose, and includes computer viruses, worms, trojans, and spyware
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4 Related Policies

ITWORKS/171	IT WORKS Information Security Policy
ITWORKS/178	Staff Internet Access Policy
ITWORKS/185	Management and Use of Electronic Messaging Policy
ITWORKS/170	Cyber Security Incident Reporting Policy

5 Procedure

This procedure defines IT WORKS guidelines and standards relating to the prevention and detection of malicious software and will assist in ensuring:

- appropriate controls are in place to reduce the potential for impact from malicious software.
- staff are aware of their responsibilities and obligations with respect to control of malicious software.

5.1 Malicious Software Threats

Desktops, laptop computers, and file servers are susceptible to malicious software, and as such IT WORKS has implemented protection software in these environments. This software aims to detect malicious software before it is introduced and to remediate existing infections. However, new malicious software is continually being developed and although the protection software is regularly upgraded to keep pace with those developments, it is unrealistic to expect any software to provide complete protection. It is therefore important for all personnel to be careful that they do not introduce malicious software to the IT WORKS computer environment, and to be diligent in detecting malicious software and reporting it immediately to the ICT Service Desk.

5.2 Servers

Malicious software protection software is to be installed on IT WORKS servers to protect information stored on the server by automatically scanning all files as they are written or accessed and removing any malicious software detected.

Automated updates of the malicious software protection software will be implemented on IT WORKS servers. External service providers are responsible for implementing malicious software protection updates on the servers they manage according to the requirements of the Distributed Computing Support Services contract.

ICT Services will ensure that malicious software protection software is installed and updated on the servers it manages.

5.3 Protection of network-connected devices

All network-connected IT WORKS desktop and laptop computers will be protected by malicious software protection software. ICT Services will ensure that this software is installed on all new equipment. Automated updates to this software will be implemented by ICT Services.

Users must not interfere with or attempt to circumvent the operation of the malicious software protection software.

5.4 Protection of non-network connected devices

Malicious software protection software must be installed and maintained on all stand-alone IT WORKS computer equipment. The ICT Service Desk will provide users with copies of this software, instructions for installation, and instructions for maintenance of its updates.

5.5 Malicious Software Detection

Users must contact the ICT Service Desk if they receive a notification on their device indicating that malicious software has been detected and/or eradicated. ICT Services will coordinate actions to prevent any further distribution of the malicious software.

5.6 Email Protection

Incoming and outgoing email is scanned for malicious software. Emails from these services advising of malicious software detected in email messages need not be reported to the ICT Service Desk.

Email attachments are also scanned for malicious software when accessed, opened, or closed as part of IT WORKS's malicious software protection, however, care must still be taken by users when attachments are received via email.

5.7 Untrusted sources

As described in the Staff Internet Access Policy and the Management and Use of Electronic Messaging Policy users must exercise caution when visiting or downloading files from untrusted sites on the Internet and opening attachments or clicking on links in untrusted emails.

Similar caution must also be used when opening files or using untrusted removable media, such as USB drives.

Even though malicious software protection software is in place, new malicious software is continually being developed and may not yet be recognized by the installed protection software.

5.8 Malicious software hoaxes

Do not forward unconfirmed warnings of malicious software or threats

Hoax messages often ask the recipient to forward the warning to as many people as possible. This is how the hoax "spreads" itself. Users should contact the ICT Service Desk if they receive any form of malicious software-related warning asking the user to forward it to others.

The ICT Service Desk will check the authenticity of the message against known malicious software and hoax information from malicious software reference sources.

If any email message warning about a potential virus is received:

- Any associated email attachments must not be opened.
- The ICT Service Desk must be contacted, who will arrange to check whether the warning is a hoax or if it relates to a real threat.
- The message is not to be forwarded to other users.

6 Authentication and Responsibilities

6.1 Specific responsibility of IT WORKS staff

All IT WORKS staff are required to comply with the Information Security Policy and related policies, procedures, and standards of IT WORKS, the Code of Ethics, and to play an active role in protecting information assets.

6.2 Review of this Procedure

IT WORKS Policy must be reviewed at least every two years, but may be actioned earlier according to strategic priorities, reforms, or feedback received.